Newspapers by ancestry
https://www.newspapers.com/image/311923582/
The Indianapolis News (Indianapolis, Indiana) · Tue, Apr 16, 1957 · Page 14
Downloaded on May 14, 2025

New Suited, New Faced Indians to Open Season Under New Pilot Here Tonight

Only 3 Holdovers From Triple Champs

By LESTER KOELLING

With shouts of praise still ringing in their ears, the Indianapolis Indians hope to prove themselves at 7:45 tonight in the American Association season-opener against the Minneapolis Millers.

KOELLING PICKS

1. St. Paul
2. Denver
3. Minneapolis
4. Omaha
5. INDIANAPOLIS
6. Wichita
7. Charleston
8. Louisville

From Mayor Phil Bayt on down through various other speakers, the Indians were patted on the back at the annual Ipalco Club dinner last night as another championship team. But the "experts," the boys in the league who write about baseball, have another version.

Koelling

They see the 1957 Indians, following in the footsteps of last year's triple champions, as finishing seventh in the current A.A. pennant race. Of 19 writers making selections, one picked the Indians fifth, 15 put them seventh, and three rated them last. Last year, the writers proved how wrong they can be by selecting the Tribe to finish sixth.

The "new look" Indians of 1957 again could fool the forecasters, but some added strength will be necessary. The Indians, as they are now, lack power and speed; they are fairly sound defensively, especially in the infield, and they appear potentially strong in pitching.

Whatever success they will experience beyond their seventh-place selection will depend upon how well the combination of veteran and young pitching responds, and whether the current weak spots in offense and defense will improve beyond expectations. In short, the Indians are surrounded by "ifs."

One of the biggest problems confronting the field strategists will be the selection of a pitching staff that will carry on through the season. At present, the Tribe roster contains 14 hurlers and probably not more than nine will be carried after the league player limit of 20 goes into effect May 16.

The problem is aggravated by the fact that a few have not yet thrown a ball for the Indians, and several others have made only brief appearances in exhibition games. One—Tom Flanigan, the most recent addition—already has been placed on the inactive list due to the fact that the Indians were one over the 24-player limit for the first month of the the season.

Principal reason for the low rating of the Indians is that the powerful 1956 club has vanished from the league almost without trace. Only Ted Beard and George Spencer are left from the pennant winners and Junior World Series champions. In their place are chattels from the Chicago White Sox, the new "parent" club, and a sprinkling of "old-timers" bought by the community-owned Indians.

Picked to win the championship this year are the Denver Bears, who had things pretty much their own way last year until the Indians started their famous last-month drive. Wichita was rated second, Omaha third and Minneapolis fourth.

Only familiar face in the Tribe's starting lineup tonight will be that of Beard in center field, one of eight players now owned outright by Indians, Inc. Other players owned by the club's 6,672 stockholders in the starting lineup will be Vince Garcia, second baseman bought from Wichita; Jim Delsing, outfielder bought from the White Sox, and possibly Charley Williams, infielder bought from Nashville, and Al Papai, pitcher bought from Memphis.

Manager Andy Cohen, facing a challenge in following a leader who directed the Indians to two pennants in three years, said his starting pitcher will be Barry Latman, a 20-year-old fast-baller. The youngster compiled an impressive record of 2 earned runs in 22 innings during spring exhibition games.

The opposing Minneapolis Millers, also featuring considerable new talent, likewise have a new manager in Red Davis, who directed Dallas in the Texas League the last two seasons. But the Millers have a strong nucleus of holdovers from the fourth-place 1956 club in addition to several proven Triple A performers from other clubs.

HOW A.A. WRITERS SEE FLAG RACE

	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	*Pts.
Denver	9	4	3	1	2	0	0	0	131
Wichita	2	6	5	2	3	1	0	0	113
Omaha	3	3	4	4	1	4	0	0	105
Minneapolis	2	5	2	3	1	5	1	0	99
St. Paul	3	0	3	4	5	4	0	0	94
Charleston	0	1	2	5	6	4	1	0	82
INDIANAPOLIS	0	0	0	0	1	0	15	3	37
Louisville	0	0	0	0	0	1	2	16	23

*Points computed on the basis of 8 for first-place votes, 7 for second, 6 for third, etc.

Installations Stall Annual Tournament

THE HONOR ROLLS

MEN

John Dezelan	689
Walt Gillespie	638
Russell Hart	636
Jim Shewman	630
James Warman	626
Frank Davis	621
Robert Dickinson	621
Fonnie Snyder	618
Max Harper	616
Bill Mattox	615
Glen Bowers	613
Jack Sullivan	612
Pug Leppert	612
Joe Keating	611
Norb Roeder	608
William Richardson	607
Bob Camagun	606
William Rickey	603
Gene Blanford	603
Gene Crim	603
Ed Titsworth	603
Dave Burns	602
George Huber	601
Jim Kemmerer	601
Ora Downs Sr.	600
Dan Jones	600

WOMEN

Frances Tank	593
Tillie Kampovsky	564
Jean Wheatley	550
Rita Shumate	545
Gerry Arnold	544
Mabel Becker	544
Gladys King	540
Willa Murrell	540
Ann Richmond	537
Jessie Schifferdecker	535
Phyllis Demma	534
Deloris Smith	529
Artie Stephenson	525
Helen Stewart	522
Mary Loughmiller	519
Ada Cantwell	517
Mickey Specht	516
Eloise Webb	514
Betty Bradley	513
Helen Quintel	513
Mary Conrad	512
Dorothy Link	511
Dorothy Dilley	509
Helen Rosebrock	508
Mary Jewell	504
Dude Weatherly	504
Myrtle Scott	502
Jo Sterba	502
Phyllis Wilcox	502
Helen Baidwag	501
Mae Wiese	501

By FRANK WILSON

Installation of automatic pinspotters is occupying many of the city's bowling lanes, and it's the reason the annual Husband and Wife tourney in Speedway Bowl will be delayed until June.

Usually an April-May event, the handicap event run by Del England will start June 1 and close June 9.

Reason is the installation of Brunswick automatics during the usual tournament period. England is awaiting delivery of the pinspotters now.

Prizes in the event will be $150 first money in handicap and $100 for actual pins, based on 200 entries. The tab is $9 including prize, entry and bowling fees. Entries will be accepted through the final evening of the tourney. Further information can be obtained from Velma Markins, ME 6-4133.

* * *

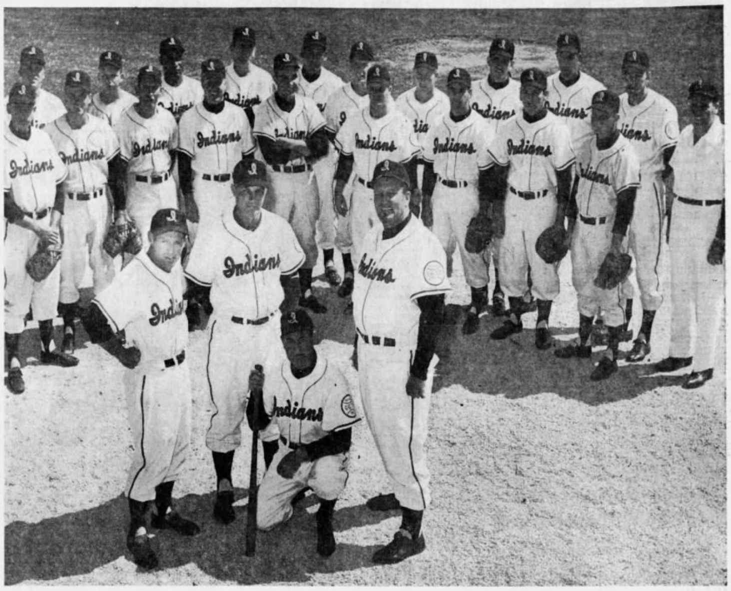
The ABC Masters tournament went into its quarter-final rounds today with the familiar names much in evidence. Among those still in the running are Dick Hoover of Akron, Lou Sielaff of Detroit, and Bill Lillard, Adolph Carlson, Buddy Bomar and Joe Kristof of Chicago.

The championship will be decided tomorrow night.

* * *

Tom Joyce 7-Up scored 2,307 and Union Federal Savings and Loan 1,867 in WIBC tournament firing in McCook Bowl in Dayton. Maxine Thayer and Louise Peterson hit 1,040 in the doubles, and Louise collected 534 in the singles.

In the ABC in Ft. Worth, Pritchett-O'Grady Majors collected 2,692 and Beam's Central Alley Five worked 2,624. Bill McGregor's 641 was tops for Pritchett-O'Grady. In the doubles, Roy Moulden and Dave James worked 1,111, and McGregor scored 584 in the singles.



Your 1957 Indians

Here are your 1957 Indianapolis Indians, who are scheduled to open the season tonight against the Minneapolis Millers. Grouped behind the kneeling Manager Andy Cohen are the only holdovers from last year's championship team—Ted Beard, George Spencer and Coach Johnny Hutchings. In the semi-circle behind them are, left to right, Charley Bicknell, Dick DiTusa, Glen Rosenbaum, Ed Szyczewski, Rodolfo Arias, Sam Hairston, Arnie Atkins, Don Prohovich, Don Rudolph, Tony Ponce, Jim Delsing, Bill DuFour, Dick Means, Vince Garcia, Barry Latman, John Romano, Ron Jackson, Charley Williams, Al Papai, and Trainer Angelo (Tiny) Tunis. Four others on the roster—Jose Valdivielso, Roger Howard, Tom Flanigan and Joe Dahlke were not present when the picture was made. The News Photo—Dean Timmerman.

Doherty Sees Two Million Gate for A.A.

By Associated Press

DENVER—Ed Doherty, president of the American Association said today he has high hopes that the 1957 season for his circuit will be a "tremendous success both on the field and at the turnstiles."

Doherty, in a preview of the 56th consecutive season for the league, said:

"New stadia at Louisville and St. Paul, the cut-down rule which gives new stability to our opening day rosters and a general resurgence of interest in baseball combine to make me so optimistic that I am predicting a two-million gate for the American Association.

"I look for a highly competitive year between Minneapolis and St. Paul, both of whom appear to have fine clubs. Not since 1952 have both the Millers and Saints finished in the first division in a given season, but off their 1957 spring showings they figure as definite contenders.

"Denver, the National Association attendance leader the past two seasons, has another fine club with interest again running very high. Indianapolis and Charleston have enjoyed sensational advance sales and things are moving well in Louisville, Wichita and Omaha.

"After seing all clubs in the South, most of them two or three times, I am looking forward to a tight race and a hot scramble for the pennant."

NOT TOO LATE TO GET SEATS

A generous supply of good seats is still available for tonight's season baseball opener between the Indianapolis Indians and Minneapolis Millers. All seats for the opening game are reserved at regular season prices of $1.10 for grandstand, $1.40 for the first eight rows of grandstand, and $1.70 for box seats. They may be obtained at Victory Field or at the Ross and Babcock Bureau in the Claypool Hotel.

Advance ticket sales for the opener and for the season continued to climb above the all-time record which was reached several days ago. The total advance sales at noon today was $65,485.

AT VICTORY FIELD TONIGHT

MINNEAPOLIS	INDIANAPOLIS
Felipe Alou, cf	Dick Means, lf
Wayne Terwilliger, 2b	Vince Garcia, 2b
Hank Thompson, lf	Ted Beard, rf
Carlos Paula, rf	Ron Jackson, 1b
Orlando Cepeda, 1b	Don Prohovich, 3b
Jim Davenport, 3b	Jim Delsing, cf
Ed Bressoud, ss	Charlie Williams, ss
Jake Jenkins, c	John Romano, c
Stu Miller, p	Barry Latman, p

UMPIRES—Walter Doyle, Bill Kinnamon and Jerry VanKeuren.

GAME TIME—7:45.

PREGAME CEREMONIES—7:15.

"You can't blame them much, J. B.—The salmon must be running!"

AMERICAN ASSOCIATION

TONIGHT'S PITCHERS

Minneapolis (Miller) at INDIANAPOLIS (Latman)
Denver (Lasorda) at Louisville (Benedict).
St. Paul (Williams or Templeton) at Wichita (Gorin).
Omaha (Morford) at Charleston (Preskel).

TOMORROW NIGHT'S GAMES

Minneapolis at INDIANAPOLIS.
Denver at Louisville.
St. Paul at Wichita.
Omaha at Charleston.

16-Year Tally on Tribe's Opening Crowds

1941—5,489 1949—12,343
*1942—11,546 1950—10,101
1943—10,533 1951—6,713
1944—10,146 1952—11,681
1945—6,666 1953—5,661
1946—11,090 1954—7,508
1947—9,936 1955—4,550
1948—11,871 *1956—1,998

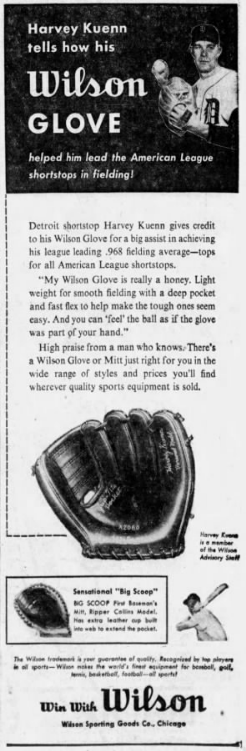
* Day Games

INDIANS OPENER
TONITE
at 7:45 P.M.
Indianapolis vs. Minneapolis
Pre-Game Ceremonies 7:15 P.M.
ALL SEATS RESERVED
GET TICKETS TODAY
Victory Field Box Office
or Ross and Babcock, Claypool Hotel

LOOK FOR
YOUR LETTER
FROM
LIFE

Coming tomorrow

It's your one chance for a year to get LIFE regularly for only 10¢ a copy.


Harvey Kuenn tells how his Wilson GLOVE helped him lead the American League shortstops in fielding!

Detroit shortstop Harvey Kuenn gives credit to his Wilson Glove for a big assist in achieving his league leading .968 fielding average—tops for all American League shortstops.

"My Wilson Glove is really a honey. Light weight for smooth fielding with a deep pocket and fast flex to help make the tough ones seem easy. And you can 'feel' the ball as if the glove was part of your hand."

High praise from a man who knows. There's a Wilson Glove or Mitt just right for you in the wide range of styles and prices you'll find wherever quality sports equipment is sold.

Harvey Kuenn is a member of the Wilson Advisory Staff

Sensational "Big Scoop"
BIG SCOOP First Baseman's Mitt, Rippey Collins Model. Has extra leather cup built into web to extend the pocket.

The Wilson trademark is your guarantee of quality. Recognized by top players in all sports—Wilson makes the world's finest equipment for baseball, golf, tennis, basketball, football—all sports!

Win With Wilson
Wilson Sporting Goods Co., Chicago

Copyright © 2025 Newspapers.com. All Rights Reserved.